

## From Local Roots to Global Learning

# A GREAT Scholar's Story

**Coming from a rural background in Punjab and transitioning from a non-technical degree to MSc Data Science in the UK, what has your journey been like so far?**

Growing up in Punjab, opportunities to explore fields like data science were not always easily available. However, I always had a strong interest in mathematics and analytical thinking, which became the foundation of my academic journey. During my undergraduate studies in the non-medical stream, subjects such as calculus, linear algebra, and numerical analysis strengthened my problem-solving abilities and curiosity about data. When I decided to move toward Data Science, I began learning programming languages like Python through online resources and regular practice. Although transitioning into a more technical field was challenging at first, it was also very rewarding. Studying MSc Data Science in the UK has expanded my perspective and given me valuable exposure to a global academic environment.

**What motivated you to pursue Data Science at Liverpool Hope University, and how did you feel when you were awarded the GREAT Scholarship?**

My interest in mathematics and analytical thinking gradually led me toward the field of data science. I enjoy working with data, solving problems, and understanding patterns that can help improve decision making in real life situations. The MSc Data Science programme at Liverpool Hope University attracted me because it focuses on important areas such as Machine Learning, Numerical Methods, and Big Data, which are essential for developing strong analytical and technical skills. The practical and research-oriented structure of the course felt well aligned with my career goals. When I received the GREAT Scholarship, it was a very meaningful moment for me. It felt like recognition of the effort I had put into my studies and gave me greater confidence and motivation to continue working toward my goals.

**How did the British Council's GREAT Scholarship support you both financially and personally in pursuing your studies in the UK?**

The GREAT Scholarship has supported me in a very meaningful way, both financially and personally. Financially, receiving £10,000 towards my tuition significantly reduced the burden of paying my next semester's fees. It also meant that my family did not have to carry additional financial pressure, which gave me great peace of mind. Because of this support, I have been able to focus more on my studies and personal development without constant financial stress. I can dedicate extra time to learning, practising programming, and strengthening my technical skills. Personally, being selected as a GREAT Scholar has also boosted my confidence and motivated me to work even harder in my academic journey.




**What has been the most rewarding experience during your time as a GREAT Scholar in the UK?**

One of the most rewarding aspects of being a GREAT Scholar has been the opportunity to meet and interact with other scholars at my university. It has been inspiring to hear about their academic journeys and learn from students coming from different countries and cultures. These conversations have broadened my perspective and made my experience more enriching. Another memorable moment was attending a lunch meeting at the university with members of the Study UK team from the British Council during their visit to the campus. I was also excited to see my photo featured in a GREAT Scholars reel shared on the British Council's Instagram page. Moments like these make the experience feel very special and motivating.

**What advice would you give to students, especially girls from rural communities, who are considering applying for UK scholarships?**

My advice would be to start the process, because once you begin, you understand everything step by step. Today, many learning resources and guidance are available online, so students should make full use of them. It is also important to communicate and actively ask questions. I personally emailed my university several times whenever I needed clarification, so students should not feel shy about reaching out for information. I would also encourage students to take risks and step outside their comfort zone. If something does not work out the first time, learn from the experience, improve, and try again. Focus on what you can do with the resources available and keep moving forward with confidence.